

Martin Newkirk

Product + Builder | Founder | Clean Energy & Mobility | Ex-Uber

Sydney, NSW (Australian Citizen)

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cleanenergyreviews.info | photonik.solar | martinnewkirk.online

SUMMARY

Operations and product leader with 10+ years across clean energy and transport, focused on asset performance, compliance and reporting. Co-founded Photonik, solar design software with 2,100+ installer businesses signed up.

At Car Next Door, managed fleet performance across a platform that grew to 10,000 cars, and ran planning, executive reporting and compliance through its acquisition and integration into Uber. Earlier ran solar operations, procurement and STC compliance for installers, and recently rebuilt Photonik with AI in six months.

EXPERIENCE

Photonik

Co-Founder | Product & Operations

2022 – Present | Sydney, NSW

- **Photonik is professional solar design software**, with 2,100+ installer businesses signed up and users in 190+ countries since launch, and a marketplace for homeowners to buy solar from installers
- Lead product for the solar design and system calculations that users rate as Photonik's main strength
- **Rebuilt the platform** with AI-assisted development (Claude, Cursor) in six months, then shipped 10 new core features in weekly releases
- Own the P&L and annual budget, and as company secretary manage share contracts and shareholder paperwork

Uber Carshare (previously Car Next Door)

Senior Associate, Strategy & Operations

Sep 2021 – Sep 2024 | Hybrid – Sydney, NSW

- Supported the Uber acquisition and integration, including rebrand decisions, integration frameworks and alignment with Uber's global teams
- Consolidated financial, operational and OKR data into one performance view for monthly executive reviews
- Spent 2024 as Policy, Safety & Risk Programs Lead, owning the vehicle safety policy overhaul, deactivation frameworks and safety dashboard
- Designed and piloted a delisting policy that removed underperforming vehicles and owners to improve fleet profitability and utilisation

- Launched the complaints reporting system, with analytics and frontline training, so the business met AFCA requirements
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Product Manager

Apr 2018 – Sep 2021

- Launched Key Swap after weighing installation cost, theft risk and growth. By the Uber acquisition, 10,000 cars were on the platform and 60% used Key Swap
 - Reworked onboarding and trip start to make bookings more reliable and cut cancellations
 - As Car Next Door's first product manager, set up agile delivery and quarterly OKRs from scratch
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Fleet Manager

Mar 2016 – Mar 2018

- Managed sales and operations teams to onboard new vehicles nationwide
- Launched Brisbane and quadrupled weekly installs
- Optimised fleet utilisation and reduced operational costs

Clean Energy Reviews

Founder

2014 – Present

- Built an independent solar and battery advice site with 8.3M unique visitors and 10.2M visits (2014–2025)

Newkirk Solar Services

Founder

Apr 2012 – Mar 2016 | Melbourne, VIC

- Ran solar operations for electricians and small retailers: kit supply, STC payments, and grid connection paperwork with retailers and distributors
- Managed the P&L, budget and suppliers of panels, inverters and mounting hardware
- Built a system that automated quotes, invoices and compliance paperwork (including STC forms) for electricians entering solar

Shine On

Operations Manager

Feb 2011 – May 2012 | Melbourne, VIC

- Managed supply chain, procurement, and logistics for solar installation business
- Streamlined internal processes and supplier management to improve efficiency

UK Department of Health

Business Manager

Jan 2009 – Aug 2010 | London, UK

- Supported Director General of Informatics with ministerial briefings and strategic documentation

EDUCATION

Master of Commerce — RMIT (2012, 5 units completed)

Bachelor of International Studies — International Relations & Asian Studies — Flinders University (2003 – 2007)

University Exchange, Political Science — Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile (2006)

University Exchange, Bahasa Indonesia — Universitas Gadjah Mada (2005)

High School Diploma — Adelaide High School (1997 – 2001)

INTERESTS

Strongroom Cricket Club | 2009 – Present

Dulwich Hill PS Parents and Citizens Association (P&C) | President 2024

Rock Climbing | Running | Tennis | Husband and Dad

SKILLS

Core: Asset and Fleet Performance, Operations Management, Compliance and Risk, Performance Reporting and Dashboards (Looker), Supplier Management and Procurement, Budgets and P&L, Contract Management, People Management, Solar PV and STCs, AI-Assisted Development

LANGUAGES

English: Native/Bilingual

Spanish: Limited Working

Indonesian: Elementary